NSF I-Corps
Customer Interview Form

NSF I-Corps Team:	**Team #003, Fruitful Network Development**				
Entrepreneurial Lead:	Dylan Montgomery	Mentor:		Faculty Lead:	

Customer Interviews

Market Segment:	**Agricultural Network: HUB Organizer and Storefront Operator**

Customer Name:	*Email:*	*Phone:*	*Date Contacted:*
Adam Lambert	adam@ohiocityprovisions.com	216.465.2762	04 /12 /2025
Company Name:	Ohio City Provisions	*Job Title:*	Co-Owner

What 1 or 2 hypotheses are you trying to test in this interview? (Hypotheses are statements, not questions; they often start with "I think…")	**Market Validation (Speaking to industry individuals):** - **What are the current distribution needs and solutions for the AGNET** - **What are the current supply needs and solutions for the AGNET**
Use the space provided to list prepared questions, with space below each for notes, for your interview.	**Goals:** - **To understand the potential customer's top 2-3 problems** - **To understand the potential customer's current processes** - **To understand further downstream implications of the problem** - **To understand try to quantify the severity of the problem** - **To understand the limitations of the customer's current solutions** - **To understand the decision-making process** - **To understand what the current budget is for solving the problem** —---------- **Question:** - **What technological uses and costs (Website, Software, Service portals, Phones, Internet, Email, Hardware, POS, ect.)** - **What considerations are there in expanding operations?** - **What problems have you faced with short shelf life and fragile products?** - **How are internal operations challenged for a family farm (Software/hardware)?** - **And externally for family farms or other Network individuals?** - **Most costly part of being a vendor** - **How do you stay engaged** - **How have you found out about Markets and HUBs** - **What info do you wish you knew about suppliers** - **What do you wish people new** —---------- **Notes:** - **There are not many very local option for people in the area** - **They try to be a one stop shop experience so part of this involves sourcing sustainability outside the local area in the winter** - **Stays organic Domestic** - **Due to the work they do with the Amish, many of the farms are visited on rotation by driving for hours all day, giving them their printed plan for how Ohio City Provisions is planning on operating over the growing season.** - **Since there are not many businesses like Ohio City provisions, they have sort of an umbrella of companies and are semi self-sufficient, besides the farms that they work with. Those farms often serve the OCP and Fresh Fork CSA exclusively.** - **Much of their business is generated by word of mouth** - **They also work to educate the public, as well as farmers, for a common understanding of sustainable practices and the domino benefit for people to support these local networks.** - **They also have their own farm sted called "WholesomeValley Farm in Wilmot Ohio** -

What were the key things you learned from this conversation? Summarize your takeaways here.	**Notes:**
	- After speaking with Adam, and finding out that his co-owner, Tevor is also a Computer Engineer, I am interested that he still made a point to tell me about the remaining gaps in the local agricultural network. I wonder what part of the network that the two have improved upon that didn't exist before.
	- It's interesting to me devotion to establishing community connection and education as well as business security, rather than a more socialized approach like a farmers market.
	- I wonder if there was no other option other than to put themselves at the center of the operations as a bottleneck and umbrella.
	  - This benefits my cause that is trying to take advantage of an already awakened demand for local, sustainable, and healthy produce.
	  - However, part of me sees the same flaw that I see in the YBFS CSA company. In that I mean, they have amazing success and its inspiring that their mission is so ethical, however, if the people that care go away or management changes, then it becomes bad for those farms, communities, and people that have become completely dependent on that business network.
	  - Similar to the benefits of a benevolent dictator
	- I wonder if there are farms and business networks that are in this same position, that don't think they have another option because they don't have the option to organize themselves. The vacuum of a well intentioned organizer leaving a network that hinged on them, then hinged on another party without their conviction.
	
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